

Pamela Dale- Rourke

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PROFILE

Dedicated Play Therapist with extensive experience supporting children and families through specialized therapeutic interventions. Proficient in fostering communication and understanding among children, parents, and educators, ensuring that each child's unique needs are met through tailored resources and strategies. My empathetic approach prioritizes building trust and collaboration.

EDUCATION

Psychology and Criminology | University of Central Lancashire | BSc

- Completed coursework in Child Psychology, Developmental Psychology, and Therapeutic Approaches, gaining insight into the psychological needs of children.
- Engaged in practical projects focusing on case studies involving children, enhancing understanding of emotional and social dynamics.
- Participated in research initiatives that explored communication strategies for children with special needs, contributing to a broader understanding of effective therapeutic methods.

SKILLS

Strong digital skills for resource creation layout and design Mind Express 5

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and speech and language therapy educators

and families to ensure resources meet user needs

fostering trust and cooperation among children parents

ensuring effective support.

HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Writing



Meditation



Art

CERTIFICATIONS

DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care | Preston College

- Gained in-depth knowledge of attachment theory and its application in therapeutic settings.
- Developed skills in facilitating therapeutic interventions that promote emotional healing and resilience.

Play Therapy | Canterbury Christ University

- Completed extensive training in play therapy techniques, focusing on child-centered approaches that enhance emotional expression and communication.

Filial Therapy in Family Therapy | Manchester

- Engaged in practical training that emphasized the importance of family involvement in therapeutic processes, fostering better outcomes for children.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind | 10/2016 – Present | Manchester, England

- Developed and customized innovative communication and therapy resources, enhancing accessibility for children in schools with diverse needs, resulting in improved engagement.
- Delivered impactful 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy sessions, utilizing psychotherapeutic assessments to guide individualized therapeutic pathways for children.
- Collaborated with teachers and therapists, co-creating accessible materials that facilitate meaningful communication for children facing learning and social challenges.
- Supervised and mentored postgraduate Play Therapy students, providing training in resource utilization and inclusive communication strategies, fostering a supportive learning environment.
- Conducted workshops for educators on creating inclusive classroom practices, resulting in a 30% increase in teacher engagement with therapeutic strategies.
- Engaged with parents to provide guidance on effective communication techniques, enhancing family dynamics and child development outcomes.
- Initiated feedback mechanisms from families and educators to continuously improve therapy resources, ensuring they meet the evolving needs of children.
- Implemented tracking systems for children's progress, leading to measurable improvements in emotional and social skills among participants.

Play Therapist | Barnardos | 01/2015 – 10/2016 | St Helens, England

- Developed individualized visual and therapeutic resources for children referred through CAMHS, addressing their specific emotional and communication needs with a focus on effectiveness.
- Actively participated in assessment meetings, providing recommendations for appropriate communication supports for diverse cases, enhancing the referral process.
- Managed a diverse caseload of school-aged children, applying creative and resource-based strategies to effectively address a wide range of social, emotional, and communication challenges.
- Facilitated group supervision sessions focused on sharing best practices in child-centered communication strategies, fostering professional development among peers.
- Created a toolkit for parents and educators that highlighted key strategies for supporting children's emotional health, which was distributed widely to improve community awareness.
- Conducted evaluations to assess children's progress, reporting on outcomes and adjusting therapy strategies accordingly to maximize effectiveness.
- Led community outreach initiatives, educating families about available resources and support systems, which increased participation in therapeutic programs by 25%.
- Engaged in continuous professional development through workshops and training to stay informed on the latest therapeutic methods and practices.

Family Session Worker | OJs | 05/2023 – 01/2024 | Preston, England

- Provided tailored support for families with children on the autism spectrum, crafting and modifying resources that encourage meaningful engagement and communication.
- Designed inclusive group activities, ensuring children with communication differences could participate fully, resulting in increased social interaction and peer relationships.
- Collaborated closely with families and team members to assess individual needs, developing practical and user-friendly resources that improved family dynamics.
- Organized workshops for parents, focusing on strategies to enhance communication and understanding within the family unit, leading to positive feedback from participants.
- Implemented feedback from families into program development, ensuring resources were both relevant and effective in addressing real-world challenges.
- Fostered an environment of trust and openness, encouraging families to share experiences and best practices, enhancing overall therapeutic effectiveness.
- Tracked progress of children in group settings, adjusting activities to align with their evolving needs and strengths.
- Participated in multi-disciplinary team meetings, sharing insights and strategies that informed holistic support plans for children.

Plan and Resource Creator | International School | Dates not provided

- Planned and developed engaging literacy and learning resources tailored for primary-aged children, significantly enhancing their reading and writing capabilities.
- Collaborated with teachers to align resources with curriculum objectives, ensuring they are both educational and engaging for students.
- Adapted classroom activities to accommodate various learning needs, resulting in improved participation rates among students with diverse abilities.
- Conducted workshops for staff on the importance of inclusive education, promoting awareness and understanding of different learning styles.

- Developed assessment tools to monitor student progress and effectiveness of resources, leading to data-driven improvements in teaching strategies.
- Engaged with parents to gather feedback on resource effectiveness, fostering a partnership between home and school to support children's learning.
- Created a resource library for teachers, providing easy access to materials that support diverse teaching strategies and student needs.